

You received a leak, now what?

A hands-on OPSEC simulation

Alex Pyrgiotis
Freedom of the Press
Foundation

Kolja Weber
FlokiNet



Lifecycle of a tip

1. First contact

How sources learn where to send tips.

2. GrapheneOS + Signal

Hardening the mobile tipline + live demo.

3. QubesOS / SecureDrop

Dedicated machines for air-gapped processing of tips + live demo.

4. Post-handling

Store it, share it, publish it, without burning your source.



PART I

The first-contact problem

How sources learn where to send tips.

The tipline landing page

The first thing a whistleblower sees must not betray them.

- **No subdomains:** use `newsroom.org/tips` not `tips.newsroom.org`
- **No analytics:** zero trackers, zero logging
- **Tor-friendly** reachable via onion service, zero Javascript
- **Trustworthy provider:** FlokiNet or similar; no logging of visits

Before they send a thing

Your landing page must coach them:

- **Not from work:** no corporate devices, no corporate network
- **Public spaces:** cafes, libraries, anywhere with transient IPs
- **Files have fingerprints:** metadata can and will link back
- **Mum's the word:** discussing whistleblowing with anyone can be fatal

Chelsea Manning: what can go wrong

In 2010, Chelsea Manning was leaking classified documents. She felt isolated and confided in Adrian Lamo, a former "grey hat" hacker, via encrypted chat.

Manning wrote: "but im not a source for you ... im talking to you as someone who needs moral and emotional fucking support", and Lamo replied: "i told you, none of this is for print."

Spoiler alert: Lamo informed the U.S. Army

Source: [Wikipedia — Chelsea Manning](#)



PART II

GrapheneOS + Signal

Your phone as a tipline.

GrapheneOS

Harden Signal. Now.

Setting	Why it matters
Sealed sender	Signal itself can't see who's talking to whom
Disable link previews	Previews = IP leak to the server behind the link
Registration lock	Blocks SIM-swap hijacking
No notification content	Prevents lock-screen metadata leaks
No SIM card	SMS/MMS = attack surface; 0-days love SMS

Thank you

Questions? OPSEC war stories?